

Peek Behind the Curtain: How ODS Makes Cancer Data More Useful for Research

National Cancer Institute sent this bulletin at 09/03/2026 09:30 AM EDT

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September 2026

Announcements

Peek Behind the Curtain: How ODS Makes Cancer Data More Useful for Research

Data only advances discovery when researchers can actually find and use it. Our new commentary in the *Journal of the National Cancer Institute* offers a behind-the-scenes look at how the Office of Data Sharing turns that principle into practice.

We break down the three interdependent pillars that guide everything we do (Policy, Program, and Process) and show how they come together across the full research data lifecycle, from setting expectations before an award is made to enabling responsible data reuse long after a study concludes. Behind the scenes, that means developing guidance and review tools for data management plans, coordinating working groups across NCI, building resources like the Index of NCI Studies and the NCI Data Sharing Hub, and running the streamlined access processes researchers rely on.

The impact is tangible: in 2025 alone, NCI's Data Access Committee approved more than 16,000 requests for controlled-access data, with an average review time of roughly two days. That workflow is now being adopted as a model across NIH.

The result is faster, broader, FAIR access to the data driving cancer research forward. We invite you to read the full commentary and collaborate with us as we build a coordinated data ecosystem for the cancer community, one that puts patients at the center.

[Read the commentary.](#)

NCI Office of Data Sharing Impact Prize

Turning cancer research outputs into meaningful community impact.

The [NCI Office of Data Sharing \(ODS\)](#), within the National Cancer Institute (NCI) at the National Institutes of Health (NIH), is pleased to announce the **NCI Office of Data Sharing Impact Prize**. ODS serves as NCI's central coordinating office for data management and sharing policy implementation, supporting all 27 NCI Divisions, Offices, and Centers (DOCs) across the full scope of NCI's extramural and intramural research portfolio to increase the utility of NCI-funded research outputs. The NCI Office of Data Sharing Impact Prize seeks to collect ideas and strategies that advance the broad, rapid, and equitable sharing of NCI-funded cancer research outputs. **Total cash prizes: \$200,000. Submissions open through October 5, 2026.** [Read more.](#)

Events

Childhood, Adolescent and Young Adult Cancer Data Innovation Challenge: Harnessing Data and Technology. Accelerating Discovery. Improving Outcomes.

[Registration.](#)

Date and Time: September 11, 2026, 1:30 PM – 2:30 PM EDT

Speaker: Emily Boja, Branch Chief, NCI Office of Data Sharing.

Join the National Cancer Institute (NCI) Office of Data Sharing (ODS) for a pre-submission webinar introducing a new prize competition: the [Childhood, Adolescent and Young Adult Cancer Data Innovation Challenge](#) (\$17,000,000 total prize). Learn about the competition's goals, eligibility requirements, submission process, key deadlines. The session will conclude with a live Q&A to address participant questions.

Childhood Cancer Data Initiative Symposium

Join the [Childhood Cancer Data Initiative \(CCDI\)](#) Symposium on September 18, 2026, to reflect on our progress and shape what comes next in childhood cancer research. At this hybrid event, offered both in person at the National Cancer Institute (NCI) Shady Grove Campus in Rockville, MD and online, we will highlight the foundational work accomplished by CCDI so far and work together with members across the cancer research community to explore opportunities to accelerate discovery and improve outcomes for children, adolescents, and young adults through an interoperable data ecosystem and innovative use of AI.

We invite all members of the community to attend – [register today!](#)

NCI ODS Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium

Join NCI and cancer research colleagues as we gather for the [Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium](#), a free hybrid event!

On November 5th and 6th, the NCI Office of Data Sharing (ODS) is hosting the Annual Data Sharing Symposium *Data to Discovery: Leveraging Cancer Data in the “Real World.”* This event will focus on the advancement of cancer research by leveraging real world cancer data through sharing and reuse. [Register here.](#)

Our goal in ODS is to bring together experts and stakeholders throughout the cancer research community (policymakers, scientists, clinicians, and students across government, academia, industry, and advocacy) to learn from one another and explore ways to improve the implementation of new data sharing policies for the greatest public benefit.

[Email the Office of Data Sharing](#) if you would like more information or have general questions.

We'd love to hear from you! Contact the ODS team at: nciofficeofdatasharing@mail.nih.gov

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